



12-Month Urban Growing Planner

Printable monthly planner for balcony & container gardeners

\$7

Open-pollinated • Community-grown • Food sovereignty for everyone

12-Month Urban Growing Planner

For Balconies, Patios, Raised Beds & Small Spaces

Seedwarden | seedwarden.com

Print it. Write in it. Grow something.

Important Notice

This planner is educational content based on general growing principles and real-world experience. Your results will vary based on your specific climate, soil, microclimate, and growing conditions. It is not professional agricultural advice, and Seedwarden is not liable for crop outcomes. Use it as a guide, adapt it to what you observe, and learn from each season.

How to Use This Planner

This planner is designed to be printed and used — not kept as a pristine PDF on your hard drive. Write in the margins, cross things off, stick it to a clipboard in your growing space.

Before you start: Look up your USDA Hardiness Zone and your average last frost date. Both appear in the regional customization notes at the back of this planner. These two pieces of information will tell you which month's prompts apply to your actual calendar.

The planner is written for a "standard" timeline based on a Zone 6 last frost date of approximately May 1. If you're in a warmer or colder zone, see the **Regional Adjustment Guide** on the final pages to shift the schedule forward or back.

Each monthly page includes:

- What to sow (direct and indoors)
 - What to transplant outdoors
 - What to harvest
 - What to save seeds from
 - Succession planting prompts
 - A notes row for your own observations
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Seasonal Overview

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-	SEEDWARDEN SEASONAL OVERVIEW	-
-	Urban Growing Calendar	-
+-----+		
-	JAN-FEB - Indoor seed starting begins (peppers, eggplant).	-
-	- Order seeds. Plan container layouts. Rest.	-
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-	MAR - Tomatoes, basil, herbs start indoors.	-
-	- Lettuce, spinach direct sow in containers (cold).	-
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-	APR - Harden off seedlings. Move cold-tolerant crops out.	-
-	- Last indoor sowings of summer crops.	-
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-	MAY - Last frost. All crops go out. Season begins in full.	-
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-	JUN - Peak transplant and succession sowing.	-
-	- Warm-season crops establishing. First harvests.	-
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-	JUL - Peak harvest. Tomatoes, cucumbers, peppers fruiting.	-
-	- Start fall crops indoors (kale, chard, broccoli).	-
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-	AUG - Midsummer succession sowing. Fall planting begins.	-
-	- Seed saving underway.	-
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-	SEP - Transition month. Cool crops go in, warm crops wind	-
-	- down. Major harvest and preservation push.	-
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-	OCT - Final harvests. First frosts. Protect tender crops.	-
-	- Garlic goes in the ground.	-
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-	NOV-DEC - Season close. Clean containers. Dry and store seeds.	-
-	- Review notes. Plan next year.	-
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JANUARY

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-	JANUARY	SEEDWARDEN
-	Urban Growing Planner	-
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CALENDAR			
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-	SOW INDOORS	- TRANSPLANT OUT	- HARVEST
-	-	-	-
-	• Peppers & eggplant	- Nothing yet	- Stored roots/squash
-	(8-10 wks before LF)	-	- from last season
-	• Onions from seed	-	- Indoor herbs
-	(10-12 wks before LF)	-	-
-	-	-	-
+-----+			
-	SEED SAVING	-	SUCCESSION PROMPT
-	-	-	-
-	Finish sorting and	-	Plan your succession schedule now.
-	storing seeds from	-	How many lettuce sowings do you want?
-	last season.	-	Mark target dates in Feb-May.
-	Label everything.	-	-
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-	NOTES / OBSERVATIONS		
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January Focus: This is the planning month. Order seeds before varieties sell out — heirlooms especially go fast. Audit last year's saved seeds. If you're starting peppers and eggplant, January is when Zone 6 growers need to get those going (count 10 weeks back from your May 1 last frost). Set up your seed starting station and make sure your grow light is working.

Zone note: Zones 8–10: You may already be growing cool-season crops outdoors. See Regional Adjustment Guide.

FEBRUARY

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- FEBRUARY	SEEDWARDEN	-	
- Urban Growing Planner		-	
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- SOW INDOORS	- TRANSPLANT OUT	- HARVEST	-
-	-	-	-
- • Tomatoes (late Feb, - Nothing yet	- Indoor herbs	-	
- 6-8 wks before LF) -	- Sprouts	-	
- • Celery (10-12 wks) -	- Microgreens	-	
- • Leeks (10-12 wks) -	-	-	
-	-	-	
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- SEED SAVING	- SUCCESSION PROMPT	-	
-	-	-	
- Review germination	- Mark your first lettuce sow date in March.	-	
- rates on saved seeds.	- Then add 2 more dates, 3 weeks apart.	-	
- Test old stock if	- You'll have lettuce from April through June.	-	
- uncertain.	-	-	
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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS	-		
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February Focus: For Zone 6, start tomatoes in the last week of February. Earlier than that and they'll outgrow their cells before it's warm enough to transplant. Keep heat mat under peppers that you started in

January — they're slow. Indoors, you can grow microgreens year-round in any window; this is a good low-effort project for February when you're itching to grow something.

MARCH

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- MARCH	SEEDWARDEN	-
- Urban Growing Planner		-
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- SOW INDOORS	- TRANSPLANT OUT	- HARVEST
-	-	-
- • Basil	- Lettuce (cold-hardy)	- Indoor lettuce/herbs
- • Parsley, cilantro	- Spinach	- Last of indoor sprouts
- • Lettuce (succession)	- Kale and chard	-
- • Kale, chard	- (Zone 7+ only in Mar)	-
-	-	-
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- SEED SAVING	- SUCCESSION PROMPT	-
-	-	-
- Nothing to save yet.	- Sow Batch 1 of lettuce. Mark Batch 2 for	-
- Focus on sowing.	- 3 weeks from now in the April calendar.	-
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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS		-
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March Focus: Things start moving. If you have a sheltered south-facing balcony, you can start hardening off cold-tolerant crops toward the end of the month. Spinach, kale, and lettuce can tolerate temps down to 28°F once hardened. Don't rush the tomatoes outdoors — cold soil stunts growth and the plants won't recover quickly.

APRIL

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- APRIL

SEEDWARDEN

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- Urban Growing Planner

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- CALENDAR

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- SOW INDOORS

- TRANSPLANT OUT

- HARVEST

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- • Cucumbers (late Apr) - Lettuce, spinach,

- Lettuce (if started

-

- • Zucchini (late Apr) - kale, chard (all

- early indoors)

-

- • Beans (late Apr, - zones by mid-April) - Radishes

-

- biodegradable pots) - Radish (direct sow) - Herbs

-

- • Lettuce Batch 2

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- SEED SAVING

- SUCCESSION PROMPT

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- Nothing to save yet.

- Sow Batch 2 of lettuce (3 weeks after Batch 1)

-

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- Sow Batch 1 of radishes. Mark Batch 2 for

-

-

- 2 weeks out.

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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS

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April Focus: The hardening-off marathon. Every seedling that's going outside needs to spend time adjusting to outdoor conditions before the permanent move. Be systematic about it: 1–2 hours outside on Day 1, add an hour each day, get to full days outdoors by Day 10. Watch the forecast — bring seedlings in if temps are dropping below 40°F for frost-sensitive crops.

MAY

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- MAY SEEDWARDEN -

- Urban Growing Planner * LAST FROST — SEASON OPENS * -

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- CALENDAR -

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- SOW INDOORS/DIRECT - TRANSPLANT OUT - HARVEST -

- - - - -

- • Lettuce Batch 3 - Tomatoes (after LF) - Lettuce -

- • Beans (direct sow) - Peppers (after LF + - Spinach (before bolt) -

- • Radish Batch 2 - 1–2 weeks) - Radishes -

- • Succession herbs - Basil (after LF) - Kale and chard -

- - Cucumbers, zucchini - -

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- SEED SAVING - SUCCESSION PROMPT -

- - -

- Let 1–2 spinach plants - Sow Batch 3 of lettuce. Last one before heat -

- bolt if you want to - arrives. After this, switch to bolt-resistant -

- save seed later. - varieties or wait for fall. -

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- as your seed plant - for continuous harvest. Mark your dates now. -
- — don't harvest its -
- first fruits. -

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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS -
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June Focus: The growing season has fully opened. Containers dry out faster as heat increases — check moisture daily during hot weeks. Tomatoes will start setting flowers; pinch suckers on indeterminate varieties to focus energy on fruit. First harvests are starting.

JULY

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- JULY SEEDWARDEN -
- Urban Growing Planner * PEAK HARVEST SEASON * -

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- SOW INDOORS - TRANSPLANT OUT - HARVEST -
- - -
- • Kale (fall crop, - Nothing new - Tomatoes -
- start mid-July) - (focus on established - Cucumbers -
- • Chard (fall crop) - plants) - Peppers -
- • Broccoli for fall - - Zucchini -
- (late July start) - - Beans -

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- SEED SAVING

- SUCCESSION PROMPT

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- Leave some cucumbers

- Last round of direct-sow beans (needs 60 days

- to fully mature for

- to frost). Check your frost date — is there

- seed. Mark them with

- still time?

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- a tag or ribbon.

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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS

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July Focus: Harvest often. Zucchini left on the plant for even a day or two too long becomes a bat. Tomatoes should be picked when fully colored and slightly soft. Start thinking ahead to fall — kale and chard started now will give you a second growing season starting in September.

AUGUST

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- AUGUST

SEEDWARDEN

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- Urban Growing Planner

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- CALENDAR

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- SOW INDOORS/DIRECT

- TRANSPLANT OUT

- HARVEST

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- • Lettuce (fall batch)

- Kale (started July)

- Tomatoes

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- • Spinach (direct)	- Broccoli	- Peppers	-
- • Cilantro (direct)	- Cucumbers	-	-
- • Arugula (direct)	- Zucchini	-	-
-	- Fresh beans	-	-
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- SEED SAVING	- SUCCESSION PROMPT	-	-
-	-	-	-
- Harvest dry beans for	- Sow fall lettuce now. It needs to establish	-	-
- seed saving if you	- before temps drop. Direct sow spinach and	-	-
- grew them. Tomatoes:	- arugula — both are fast and frost-tolerant.	-	-
- mark your best fruit.	-	-	-
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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS	-	-	-
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August Focus: The transition is starting even if it doesn't feel like it. Days are shortening. Start fall crops now, not in September — they need time to size up before cold weather arrives. Seed saving is in full swing: let your best tomatoes fully ripen on the vine before harvesting for seed.

SEPTEMBER

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- SEPTEMBER	SEEDWARDEN	-
- Urban Growing Planner	* FALL TRANSITION *	-
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- SOW DIRECT	- TRANSPLANT OUT	- HARVEST
-	-	-
- • Garlic (late Sept	- Fall lettuce	- Tomatoes (final push)
- in Zone 6)	- (started Aug)	- Peppers
- • Spinach (direct)	-	- Fall kale/chard
- • Last lettuce batch	-	- Beans (final)
- (Zone 7+)	-	- Cucumbers (winding
-	-	- down)
+-----+		
- SEED SAVING	- SUCCESSION PROMPT	-
-	-	-
- Tomato seed saving:	- Green tomatoes left on the vine when frost	-
- ferment, rinse, dry.	- threatens can be brought indoors to ripen on	-
- Pepper seed saving:	- a countertop. Don't leave them outside.	-
- dry pods fully first.	-	-
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- NOTES / OBSERVATIONS	-	-
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September Focus: Watch the forecast. First frost can sneak up. Have a plan for protecting heat-loving crops — a frost cloth or even old bedsheets can save your tomatoes for an extra few weeks. Harvest aggressively from anything that won't survive frost.

OCTOBER

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- OCTOBER	SEEDWARDEN	-
- Urban Growing Planner	* FIRST FROST *	-
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-	SOW	-	TASKS	-	ENJOY	-
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-	• Indoor herbs	-	Review notes from	-	Stored pantry items	-
-	• Microgreens	-	this season.	-	Pickles, preserves,	-
-	• Sprouts	-	Order or request seed	-	dried herbs	-
-		-	catalogs for next yr.	-	Microgreens	-
-		-	Plan next year's	-		-
-		-	container layout.	-		-
+-----+						
-	SEED SAVING	-	LOOKING AHEAD	-		-
-		-		-		-
-	Seeds should be	-	What worked this year? What didn't?	-		-
-	stored and labeled by	-	Write your biggest wins and lessons here	-		-
-	now. Review your	-	before you forget them.	-		-
-	collection — what do	-		-		-
-	you need to replenish?	-		-		-
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-	NOTES / YEAR-END REFLECTIONS	-		-		-
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USDA Zone Reference

Zone	Avg Minimum Winter Temp	Examples
4	-30 to -20°F	Minneapolis MN, Burlington VT
5	-20 to -10°F	Chicago IL, Denver CO, Boston MA
6	-10 to 0°F	Philadelphia PA, Columbus OH, Kansas Cit
7	0 to 10°F	Washington DC, Nashville TN, Albuquerque
8	10 to 20°F	Seattle WA, Dallas TX, Atlanta GA
9	20 to 30°F	Los Angeles CA, Houston TX, Portland OR
10	30 to 40°F	Miami FL, San Diego CA

How to Adjust

Zone 4 (colder than baseline): Shift all outdoor activities 3–4 weeks later than written. Indoor seed starting stays on the same schedule (count from your later last frost date). Your growing season is shorter — focus on fast-maturing varieties.

Zone 5 (slightly colder): Shift outdoor activities 1–2 weeks later. Count backwards from your last frost date (typically May 15–June 1) for all seed starting timing.

Zone 6 (baseline): Use the planner as written.

Zone 7 (slightly warmer): Shift outdoor activities 2–3 weeks earlier. You can start cool-season crops outdoors in late February or early March. Your fall season extends into November.

Zone 8 (warmer): Shift outdoor activities 4–6 weeks earlier. Spring planting begins in February or even January for cool crops. You'll have a true fall growing season (September–December) for cool crops. Summer heat may force a mid-season pause on cool crops.

Zone 9–10 (warm/hot climates): Warm-season crops go out in February–March. Cool crops can be grown almost year-round with a summer gap. Focus your lettuce, spinach, and kale growing in October–April. Summer (June–September) is your "rest" period for many crops.

Finding Your Last Frost Date

Search "[your city] average last frost date" or use the Old Farmer's Almanac frost date calculator. Write your dates here:

Average last frost date: _____

Average first fall frost date: _____

Approximate growing season length: _____ days

This planner is designed to be printed at home on standard 8.5" x 11" paper. The calendar pages are formatted for portrait orientation. Print single-sided for a binder, or double-sided to save paper. The notes rows are intentionally generous — use them.

— Seedwarden

seedwarden.com | Questions? Reach us through our Etsy shop.

This planner may be printed for personal use. Please do not redistribute digitally or resell.

More from Seedwarden

If you found this guide useful, you might also like:

- Apartment Seed Starting Kit (\$9) — Practical first-timer guide to starting seeds indoors with minimal equipment
- Container Growing Blueprint Pack (\$12) — Five printable layout plans sized for balconies, patios, and raised beds
- Seed Saving Field Manual (\$14) — Close the loop by saving seed from this season's best performers

Browse all Seedwarden guides at [\[our Etsy shop\]](#).